after all that had happened on the pitch, amid all the friendly back-slapping and compliments after, I just wanted to get home and see Danielle. Straight after the usual team chat, I escaped from the noise and headed home to Pretoria.

My cellphone battery was dead, and I was feeling calm and quiet as I turned left down Corlett Drive and left onto the M1 north, listening to music as I drove towards Midrand, suddenly feeling close to God.

'Thank you,' I said out aloud.

I am a Christian, a child of God.

I strongly believe this book is not my story. It is the story of what God has planned and realised through me. I hope it can be read and understood as tales of His achievements, certainly not my personal achievements, and I would really like people to appreciate that whatever glory there may be needs to be clearly recognised as His glory, not mine.

These lines will make some people feel uncomfortable. I'm sorry. Religion can have that effect. I understand it is a personal and private matter, and I certainly do not wish to ram my convictions down anyone's throat. With that said, however, my faith and my relationship with God are incredibly important to me and, after long consideration, and plenty of prayer, understanding the downside, I am not afraid publicly to recognise God's role in my life.

This doesn't mean I see myself as better than anyone else. I am not. This doesn't mean I see myself as morally superior to anyone else. I certainly am not. What it does mean, however, is that I try very hard to be receptive to the teachings of the Bible, that I am sincerely committed to the Word of God and that I aspire to lead my life in that way.

Enjoying the peace of being alone in my car, driving home from the Wanderers to Pretoria that Sunday evening, I started to look at the trees and the clouds, and began to feel sentimental, emotional even.

Quietly, privately, I recalled the two moments in my life when God